Bayesian statistics with R
6. Bayesian analyses in R with the Jags software

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Bayes in practice

Software implementation (R friendly)

Oldies but goodies:

- WinBUGS, OpenBUGS: Where it all began.
- Jags: What we will use in this course.

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If you're not into coding:

- brms: Bayesian regression models with Stan.
- MCMCglmm: Generalised Linear Mixed Models.
- Check out the CRAN Task View: Bayesian Inference for more.

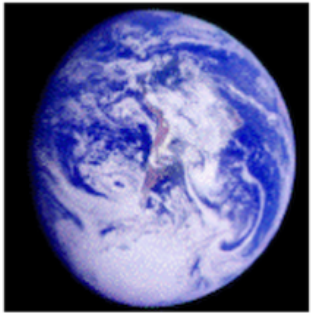
Introduction to JAGS (Just Another Gibbs Sampler)

Martyn Plummer



Real example

Impact of climatic conditions on white stork breeding success





Let's do a logistic regression on some White stork data

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- We have collected data.
- We need to build a model - write down the likelihood.
- We need to specify priors for parameters.

Read in the data

```
nbchicks <- c(151,105,73,107,113,87,77,108,118,122,112,120,122,89,69,71,
              53,41,53,31,35,14,18)

nbpairs <- c(173,164,103,113,122,112,98,121,132,136,133,137,145,117,
             90,80,67,54,58,39,42,23,23)

temp <- c(15.1,13.3,15.3,13.3,14.6,15.6,13.1,13.1,15.0,11.7,15.3,14.4,
          14.4,12.7,11.7,11.9,15.9,13.4,14.0,13.9,12.9,15.1,13.0)

rain <- c(67,52,88,61,32,36,72,43,92,32,86,28,57,55,66,26,28,96,48,90,86,
          78,87)
```

```
datax <- list(N = 23,
              nbchicks = nbchicks,
              nbpairs = nbpairs,
              temp = (temp - mean(temp))/sd(temp),
              rain = (rain - mean(rain))/sd(rain))
```

Write down the model

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{nbchicks}_i &\sim \text{Binomial}(\text{nbpairs}_i, p_i) && \text{[likelihood]} \\
\text{logit}(p_i) &= a + b_{temp}\ \text{temp}_i + b_{rain}\ \text{rain}_i && \text{[linear model]} \\
a &\sim \text{Normal}(0, 1000) && \text{[prior for } a\text{]} \\
b_{temp} &\sim \text{Normal}(0, 1000) && \text{[prior for } b_{temp}\text{]} \\
b_{rain} &\sim \text{Normal}(0, 1000) && \text{[prior for } b_{rain}\text{]}
\end{aligned}$$

Build the model

```
{
# Likelihood
    for( i in 1 : N){
        nbchicks[i] ~ dbin(p[i],nbpairs[i])
        logit(p[i]) <- a + b.temp * temp[i] + b.rain * rain[i]
        }
# ...
```

Specify priors

```
# Priors
a ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.temp ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.rain ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
}
```

Warning: Jags uses precision for Normal distributions (1 / variance)

You need to write everything in a file

```
model <-
paste("
model
{
    for( i in 1 : N)
        {
        nbchicks[i] ~ dbin(p[i],nbpairs[i])
        logit(p[i]) <- a + b.temp * temp[i] + b.rain * rain[i]
        }
a ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.temp ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.rain ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
    }
")
```

Alternatively, you may write a R function

```
logistic <- function() {
    for( i in 1 : N)
        {
        nbchicks[i] ~ dbin(p[i],nbpairs[i])
        logit(p[i]) <- a + b.temp * temp[i] + b.rain * rain[i]
        }

# priors for regression parameters
a ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.temp ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
b.rain ~ dnorm(0,0.001)
    }
```

Let us specify a few additional things

```
# list of lists of initial values (one for each MCMC chain)
init1 <- list(a = -0.5, b.temp = -0.5, b.rain = -0.5)
init2 <- list(a = 0.5, b.temp = 0.5, b.rain = 0.5)
inits <- list(init1,init2)

# specify parameters that need to be estimated
parameters <- c("a","b.temp","b.rain")

# specify nb iterations for burn-in and final inference
nb.burnin <- 10000
nb.iterations <- 20000 # beware: nb.iterations includes nb.burnin!
```

Run Jags

```
# load R2jags
library(R2jags)
# run Jags
storks <- jags(data  = datax,
               inits = inits,
               parameters.to.save = parameters,
               #model.file = "code/logistic.txt",
               model.file = logistic, # if a function was written
               n.chains = 2,
               n.iter = nb.iterations,
               n.burnin = nb.burnin)
storks
```

Inspect parameter estimates

```
#> Compiling model graph
#>    Resolving undeclared variables
#>    Allocating nodes
#> Graph information:
#>    Observed stochastic nodes: 23
#>    Unobserved stochastic nodes: 3
#>    Total graph size: 181
#>
#> Initializing model
#> Inference for Bugs model at "code/logistic.txt", fit using jags,
#>  2 chains, each with 20000 iterations (first 10000 discarded)
#>  n.sims = 20000 iterations saved. Running time = 0.387 secs
#>          mu.vect sd.vect    2.5%     25%     50%     75%   97.5%  Rhat n.eff
#> a         1.556   0.056   1.448   1.518   1.556   1.593   1.667 1.002  1200
#> b.rain   -0.157   0.060  -0.275  -0.197  -0.157  -0.116  -0.041 1.002  1500
#> b.temp    0.031   0.059  -0.085  -0.009   0.032   0.071   0.147 1.002  1300
#> deviance 204.552   2.412 201.786 202.788 203.950 205.656 210.874 1.001 20000
```

Your turn: Practical 5

MCMC makes you queens and kings of the stats world

Get all values sampled from posteriors

```
res <- as.mcmc(storks) # convert outputs in a list
res <- rbind(res[[1]],res[[2]]) # put two MCMC lists on top of each other
head(res)
#>              a     b.rain       b.temp deviance
#> [1,] 1.529521 -0.1396284 -0.001167572 202.0964
#> [2,] 1.556122 -0.1515870  0.022534876 201.6004
#> [3,] 1.536260 -0.1774452 -0.048202584 203.9664
#> [4,] 1.526734 -0.1456711 -0.027498892 202.8399
#> [5,] 1.521251 -0.1687840  0.024002878 201.9451
#> [6,] 1.523372 -0.1988665  0.028593269 202.3190
```

```
tail(res)
#>                  a     b.rain       b.temp deviance
#> [19995,] 1.613550 -0.1732345 -0.001322499 203.2112
#> [19996,] 1.633589 -0.1441979  0.005715392 203.7680
#> [19997,] 1.597541 -0.1382822  0.020619786 202.2869
#> [19998,] 1.611305 -0.1752156  0.028711117 202.8419
#> [19999,] 1.641646 -0.1371898  0.025158232 204.1396
#> [20000,] 1.656025 -0.1436038  0.029342597 204.9911
```

Compute a posteriori Pr(rain < 0)

```
# probability that the effect of rainfall is negative
mean(res[,'b.rain'] < 0)
#> [1] 0.99655
```

Compute a posteriori Pr(temp < 0)

```
# probability that the effect of temperature is negative
mean(res[,'b.temp'] < 0)
#> [1] 0.29905
```

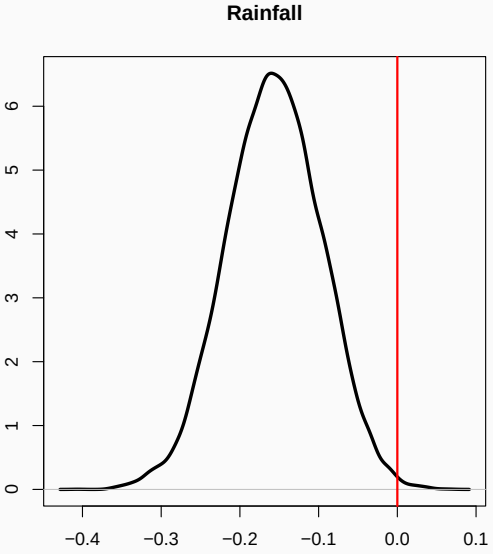
Get credible interval for the rain effect

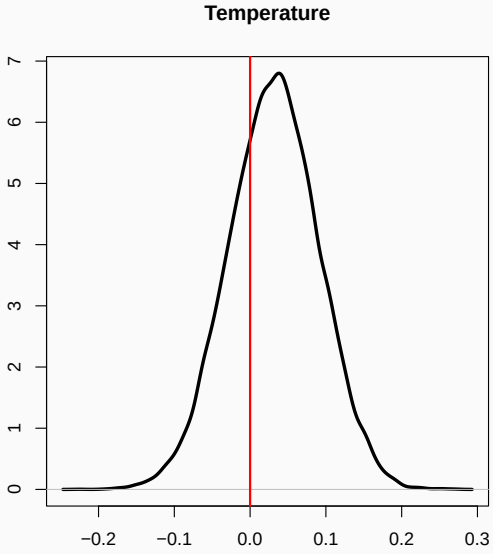
```
quantile(res[,'b.rain'],c(0.025,0.975))
#>         2.5%        97.5%
#> -0.27528694 -0.04059699
```

Get credible interval for the temperature effect

```
quantile(res[,'b.temp'],c(0.025,0.975))
#>       2.5%      97.5%
#> -0.0851964  0.1465386
```

Graphical summaries





Your turn: Practical 6